

It's All About Jesus

April 27 - June 1, 2025

Overview

Easter Tide is meant to be a time of celebration and joy. During Easter, we rejoice at the resurrection and give thanks for the gift of eternal life.

To that end, each Sunday during these 50 Great Days has a specific focus of celebration. Throughout the season, we will celebrate God's calling on our church, our seniors, infants, mothers, and all those joining our church!

As we join in celebration together, we do so by remembering that all of these celebrations are possible because of Jesus. It's all about Jesus. We believe that Christ is always with us and often appears in less-than-expected ways. Jesus appeared to the disciples many times after the resurrection, and each appearance has a story to tell. During Easter Tide we will look at each of these appearances and ask how Jesus may be appearing in a similar fashion in each of our lives.

The success of this series will be evaluated by:

- The quality of execution for each celebration.
- How well our congregation can identify Jesus' post-Easter appearances.
- How many total people participate in each of the celebratory offerings.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
4/27/25	A Walk To Remember	Luke 24:13-35
5/4/25	The Locked Room	John 20:19-23, 24-29
5/11/25	The Ghost	Luke 24:36-49
5/18/25	Forgiven Not Forgotten	John 21:15-19
5/25/25	I Am Always With You	Matthew 28:16-20
6/1/25	Carried Up	Luke 24:50-52

Week 1 | A Walk To Remember | Luke 24:13-35

Have you ever been driving home, and it seemed like the time between where you left and where you arrived went by in the blink of an eye? You are so used to the journey and so lost in thought that the space and time of your travel do not match reality. I wonder if that is how the disciples were feeling after the events of that afternoon. They were walking a well-known path. Having a conversation about what took place. They were joined by a stranger, invited him in, he broke bread, their eyes were opened, and then he was gone.

Like all the sudden they were in their house eating and wondering, “what just happened? How did we get here?”

Isn't it often that Jesus is with us, and we don't even realize it until after the fact, and we are left asking, “How did I get here? Or how did I miss it?”

Week 2 | The Locked Rooms | John 20:19-23, 24-29

A lot is made of Thomas' doubt. However, we sometimes miss the fact that twice Jesus showed up in a locked room. I wonder if David Copperfield got his inspiration not from Houdini but Jesus. Twice in one week the disciples were together, locking the door out of fear, and on both occasions Jesus was not thwarted by their bolts.

On Easter Jesus overcame death and said do not be afraid. Yet days and a week later the disciples were hiding in a locked room out of fear. When Jesus shows up he says, "peace be with you." Easter is the reminder that we need not fear.

Week 3 | The Ghost | Luke 24:36-49

Jesus' appearance is so unusual, the disciples thought they were seeing a ghost. We laugh now, but their assumption makes sense. If any of us were to see someone after they died we would assume either we were hallucinating or that we were seeing a ghost. Before Jesus, and since, no one had ever come back in the flesh. The mere fact that Jesus did show up is *supernatural* - beyond what is normal. Jesus is the one that shows up in ways that we cannot predict, and does things we could never imagine.

Week 4 | The Disciples, and Peter | John 21:15-19

There is no better picture of grace than the words "and Peter." Jesus tells the women to go tell the disciples and Peter. He doesn't single anyone else out by name. Just Peter. When Peter hears the news, he sprints off to the tomb, desperate for their message to be true. Because Peter was the one who never believed he could betray Jesus and was horrified by his actions when Jesus' prediction came to fruition.

Jesus could have said to the women, "Go get the disciples but not Peter," and he would have been justified. He could have said to Peter, "Told you so." Instead, he makes a point to ensure Peter knows he is forgiven and makes sure that everyone else knows that he forgave Peter.

It is a testament to us that when Jesus shows up he shows up *for us*, yes even us. No matter what we think of our mistakes or flaws, the message from the tomb is for the disciples, *and you*.

Week 5 | I Am Always With You | Matthew 28:16-20

A lot is made of the Great Commission, and rightfully so. It is the mission statement and marching orders for the church. When we are trying to rally the troops on a service day or inspire the youth to go and make disciples, we reference the Great Commission.

However, our capability to live out this commission is not dependent on our own abilities. Rather, we rely on the knowledge that Christ is always with us, to the very end of the age. We can only do Christ's work because Christ is with us - because Jesus shows up. And thank God that God is always there.

Week 6 | Carried Up | Luke 24:50-52 & Ephesians 4:9-13

This is a theological sermon about the nature of God (trinity) and the Mystery of Faith. What does it mean that Jesus ascended except that he also descended to the lower, earthly regions. (Ephesians 4:9). The very fact that Jesus showed up at all is a miracle. Jesus descended from heaven to earth. Christ incarnate is the miracle that creates the possibility of the ascension. We are glad that Christ dwells in heaven with God the Father and the Holy Spirit. And we are only able to know this, and celebrate it, because Christ the Son showed up in our world. Christ has died. Christ is risen. And Christ will come again.